GEP2001
Co-op Job Search 1

Course Outline

2025-2026

Pre-requisite(s)	N/A
Co-requisite(s)	N/A
Prepared by	Tetyana Semenovych
Approved by	Thandiwe Ncube, Manager, Student Talent Development
Approval date	Friday, July 25, 2025
Normative hours	21.00
Grading system	No Grades Required

Applicable Program(s)	Level	Core/Elective
Multiple Programs	Multiple Levels	Multiple Core/Elective

Land Acknowledgement

Algonquin College campuses in Ottawa, Perth and Pembroke are located on the traditional unceded, and unsurrendered territory of the Anishinàbe Algonquin People. The Algonquin People have inhabited and cared for these lands since time immemorial. We take this time to express our gratitude and respect to them and to the land for all that it has provided and will continue to provide.

As a post-secondary institution, we acknowledge the harms done to Indigenous Peoples and are committed to learning from the past. We pledge to promote healing and resilience as we move forward in partnership with the Algonquin Nations, First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Peoples in a spirit of reconciliation.

While we recognize that territorial acknowledgements are only one step in cultivating greater respect and inclusion of Indigenous Peoples, we commit to accompanying these words with actions. We are dedicated to building a future and community that is better for all.

We pledge to continue exploring and making meaningful contributions to the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada's Calls to Action.

Learn more about the College's commitment to Truth and Reconciliation: https://www.algonquincollege.com/tri

Course Description

Students are guided through a self-directed co-op job search using Algonquin's web-based resource centre, HireAC, as well as independent resources. Students will access information on key job search processes, including Co-op and Career Centre job search procedures and how to declare a self-developed job that meets co-op guidelines. Students will apply and further develop their knowledge on networking, interview techniques and job search strategies to improve their chances of success in securing co-op employment through a competitive job search process. Additional support is provided through individual coaching and group sessions, including job application reviews, mock interviews and assistance for students experiencing unique employment challenges.

Course Learning Outcomes / Elements of Performance

When you have earned credit for this course, you will have demonstrated the ability to:

1. Develop a clear understanding of the Co-op job search process, including key deadlines, required tasks, and student responsibilities.

1.1 Utilize group and individual job search support through the Co-op and Career Centre, and apply available tools and services to navigate the competitive job market effectively
1.2 Review and apply the Co-op Terms and Conditions to real-world scenarios.
1.3 Identify and follow essential Co-op procedures, including: booking interviews and accepting job offers, declaring self-developed jobs (within or outside Canada) that meet Co-op guidelines, applying for the Entrepreneurship (eCo-op) program, completing security screening and other compliance requirements.
1.4 Maintain progress in the Co-op job search by meeting all deadlines, using planning tools, and applying organization strategies to stay proactive and on track.
1.5 Identify available support services at the conclusion of the job search term.

2. Conduct a professional, self-directed job search that is supported by industry research and job goals, and incorporates a variety of job search strategies.

2.1 Navigate HireAC, Algonquin's web-based job portal, to apply for Co-op opportunities that align with program learning outcomes.
2.2 Research and apply to job opportunities using independent resources, in accordance with Co-op guidelines.
2.3 Practice and apply effective interview strategies, including participation in mock interviews.
2.4 Prepare tailored job applications that align with specific job requirements and employer expectations.
2.5 Identify and implement job search strategies that align with your target industry and current labour market conditions.
2.6 Access resources for students with diverse employment needs.

3. Prepare for a successful Co-op work term by reviewing best practices related to communication, professionalism, ethics in the workplace, and student responsibilities.

3.1 Understand employer expectations related to communication, professionalism, and workplace ethics.
3.2 Identify strategies to build a strong professional reputation during the work term.
3.3 Review Co-op work term assignments and associated timelines.
3.4 Assess your readiness for the work term and develop a personal success plan.

Learning Resources

Job Seekers Guide for Students and Graduates with Disabilities. Developed by the David C. Onley Initiative for Employment and Enterprise Development—a partnership between the University of Ottawa, Algonquin College, La Cité, and Carleton University—this guide offers tailored strategies and resources to support students with disabilities in their job search.

- https://algonquin-academic-success.libguides.com/career-platform/job-seeker-disabilities

Materials from DS_22X_LAC0000 – Cooperative Education Readiness, Online Learning. This resource was created with funding from the Government of Ontario and supported by eCampusOntario's Virtual Learning Strategy. It provides foundational knowledge and skills for Co-op readiness.

Interactive online modules from Work Integrated Learning (WIL) Open Module Initiative. The WIL Open Module Initiative is the result of a collaboration between Algonquin College, Niagara College, Georgian College, and Lambton College. These modules are grounded in The Higher Education Quality Council of Ontario's (HEQCO) A Practical Guide for Work Integrated Learning.

The AC Career Platform. Available through the Algonquin College Library Guides, this online platform offers step-by-step resources, templates, and instructions for all stages of the job search process—from crafting resumes and cover letters to preparing for interviews.

- https://algonquin-academic-success.libguides.com/career-platform/

Be the Boss of Your Career A Complete Guide for Students & Grads Handbook.

- https://www.algonquincollege.com/coop-career-centre/files/2025/01/2025-01-22-AC-CCC-Be-The-Boss.pdf

Learning Activities

Process summaries and guides
Checklists and planning tools
Flowcharts
Power Point presentations
Educational videos, how-to videos and tutorials
Online session recordings
Web-based resources

Course Related Information

The Co-op Job Search is offered to Co-op students during their Co-op job search term(s), one semester prior to each scheduled Co-op Work Term. The activities and resources in this module are designed to enhance students' Co-op experience through targeted job search support.

Program Information

College Related Information

Algonquin College's policies have been developed to ensure the health, safety and security of all students, faculty and staff, and the proper and fair operation of the College as an academic institution and employer. Please refer to the Algonquin College Policies website for the most current policy information available at http://www.algonquincollege.com/policies/.

Students are especially encouraged to be aware of the following College expectations

Academic Integrity
Algonquin College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity, and students are expected to uphold these standards throughout their learning journey with the College and post-graduation. Any academic work submitted by a student is expected to be their own work, unless designated otherwise, all human and technological assisted generated sources must be attributed. Refer to the College's Library web site for attribution support and resources. All students are expected to be familiar with the College's AA48: Academic Integrity policy which outlines student and staff roles and responsibilities, the process for addressing, determining and ruling final academic decisions regarding violations of academic integrity as well as what represents academic misconduct. Students with any questions about academic integrity course expectations including but not limited to use of technology, generative AI and other resources to support completion of coursework, are encouraged to speak to their professor and refer to the course weekly schedule, assessment instructions, course announcements and materials.

Centre for Accessible Learning (CAL)
Students with visible and/or non-visible disabilities are encouraged to register with the Centre for Accessible Learning (CAL) in order to be eligible for appropriate learning supports and/or accommodations. Students are strongly encouraged to make an appointment with the Centre for Accessible Learning as early as possible when starting a program. Once your needs are identified, a Letter of Accommodation (LOA) will be issued which you can share with your professors through the CAL Student Portal. If you are a returning student, please ensure that professors are given a copy of your LOA each semester.

Test Accommodations for Students Registered with CAL
Students who require testing accommodations will book their tests/exams through the CAL Student Portal. It is important to note the posted test/exam booking deadlines for the term. Test booking deadlines are communicated through CAL Disabilities Counsellors, CAL Testing Services, and other college wide communication. Additional information on the steps to book accommodated tests/exams with CAL Test Services can be found at Step-by-Step Overview.

Retroactive Accommodations
Students are expected to meet evaluation and completion deadlines as stated in course outline and weekly schedule documents. In circumstances where evaluation deadlines are missed or student performance has been affected by a temporary, significant and/or unanticipated change in functional ability related to disability (including mental health), interim or retroactive accommodations may be considered. For these instances it is advised you reach out to CAL or your professors as soon as possible. For other situations where deferral of evaluations may be warranted, please consult Algonquin College Policy AA21: Deferred Evaluation.

Network Credentials and College Email
Students at Algonquin College are provided with a college email account. This is the address that will be used when the College, your professors, or your fellow students communicate important information about your program or course activities. Your network credentials can be found in the ACSIS portal and you are expected to check your Algonquin email regularly and to use it to send and receive college-related email. Students are required to maintain the privacy of their AC login credentials. Sharing network credentials poses a security risk and is subject to disciplinary action. Your responsibility to protect your login credentials is governed by the Information Security Policy IT01. Support is available through the college Information Technology Service (ITS) at: https://www.algonquincollege.com/its/

Mental Health and Wellness Supports
Canada has launched a national Suicide Helpline at www.988.ca and a wide range of mental health and wellness resources for Algonquin students are available at www.algonquincollege.com/SSS/student-health-wellness.

Student Course Feedback
Algonquin College invites students to share their course experience by completing a student course feedback survey for each course they take. For further details consult Algonquin College Policy AA25: Student Course Feedback.

Use of Mobile Devices in Class

With the proliferation of small, personal mobile devices used for communications and data storage, Algonquin College believes there is a need to address their use during classes and examinations. During classes, the use of such devices unless authorized by your professor can be disruptive and disrespectful to others. During examinations, the use of such devices is generally prohibited unless authorized by your professor. Otherwise use is considered academic dishonesty in the form of cheating. For further details consult Algonquin College Policy AA32: Use of Electronic Devices in Class

Technology Requirements

Students are required to have access to a computer and to the internet. There may also be additional technology-related resources required to participate in a course that are not included in the course materials fee, such as headphones, webcams, specialized software, etc. Details on these requirements can be found in the Weekly Schedule document of the course for each course available on Brightspace.

Transfer of Credit

It is the student's responsibility to retain course outlines for possible future use to support applications for transfer of credit to other educational institutions.

Safe Harbour

In the event of an unexpected major event (pandemic, etc.), your course may have changes that are not reflected in the Course Outline. Should this happen, the Weekly Schedule document will have updated information about your course.